

The Divine Principle Study Bible for Truth Seekers

The

HOLY BIBLE

Refined English Version

This volume contains the complete text of the 66 books of the Holy Bible.

This is a study Bible. As such, it contains footnotes and annotations which illuminate and interrelate numerous passages according to the Divine Principle, the revelation and teaching received by, and given by, Rev. Dr. Sun Myung Moon.

Brief Background Summaries for each book were compiled from information in relevant on-line articles and other study Bibles.

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1. *The end times will be transformational, not cataclysmic*

Gen 6:13; Ps 78:69; Eccl 1:4; Matt 24:7

Seemingly contrary passages:

[Isa 11:4; Mal 4:1; Matt 24:29; Luke 17:26; 1 Thess 4:16–17;

2 Pet 3:12; Rev 21:1, 5;—resolution explained in **EDP** pp. 79–108]

2. *Judgment by “fire” means judgment by the Word of God*

Isa 11:4; Jer 23:29; Mal 4:1; Luke 12:49; John 9:39; 12:48; Eph 6:17;

2 Thess 2:8; 2 Pet 3:7, 12

3. *Man has a portion of responsibility, rather than being predestined*

Gen 2:17; 3:17; 6:6; 22:16–18; Exod 32:14; 33:17–19; 34:12–13; Lev 26:3;

Num 11:20; 14:20–23, 43; 20:12, 24; 27:14;

Deut 4:27–31; 7:12; 8:20; 11:13; 28:1–2, 15; 30:19; 32:50–51;

Josh 14:9; 22:31; 24:15; 1 Sam 13:14; 15:11, 23; 28:18; 2 Sam 12:9–10;

1 Kgs 3:11–14; 13:21–22; 20:36, 42; 21:20; 2 Kgs 1:16; 10:30; 19:28;

1 Chr 15:13; 22:8; 2 Chr 16:7–8; 20:37; 21:12–15; 24:20; 25:16; Ps 91:9–10;

Isa 1:19–20; 28:15–17; 37:21–35; 65:12; 66:4; Jer 7:13–15; 13:25; 16:11–13;

18:8–10; 23:38–40; 25:8–10; 28:16; 29:15–20; 35:18–19; 39:18; 40:3; 44:23; 50:24;

Ezek 5:7–8, 11; 13:8, 22–23; 16:43; 21:24; 22:19–22; 23:28–30, 35; 25:3–7;

28:6–7; 29:6–9; 35:5–6; Hos 4:6; Amos 5:14–15; Jonah 3:10; Mal 2:2; 4:6;

Matt 7:7–8; Mark 5:34; 8:38; Luke 11:10; 19:17, 44; John 3:16; 8:43; 16:27;

Jas 5:15; Jude 18–21

Seemingly contrary passages:

[Prov 16:4; Isa 46:11; Jer 1:5; Rom 8:29–30; 9:11–13, 15–16, 21; Eph 1:4;

1 Pet 1:20;—resolution explained in **EDP** pp. 153–161]

Old Testament

also known as

The Hebrew Bible

JUDE

THE GENERAL EPISTLE OF JUDE

Brief background summary

Dating:

Scholars disagree within a range of dates from 66 AD
(36 years after the crucifixion of Jesus) and 125 AD.

Authorship:

Many scholars attribute this letter to Jude, the brother of James the Just. There is much disagreement as to who this Jude really was, but they agree that he was not the “Judas” who betrayed Jesus. Scholars widely disagree on who James the Just was, in relation to Jesus. Some believe he was Jesus’ blood brother, others his half-brother, cousin, etc. Other scholars believe that Mary, the mother of Jesus, had no other children and remained a “virgin” perpetually. Many scholars see some connection between the letter of Jude and 2 Peter.

Refer to the maps for additional background information:

CHAPTER 1

¹¹ Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to those who are called, sanctified by God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ:

¹² May mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you.

¹³ Beloved, while I was very eager to write to you about our common salvation, I was constrained to write to you exhorting you to contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all delivered to the saints.

¹⁴ **For there are certain men who crept in secretly, even those who were long ago written about for this condemnation: ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into license and immorality, and denying Jesus Christ, our only sovereign and Lord.¹**

¹⁵ Now I desire to remind you, though you already know this, that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who did not believe.

¹⁶ **The angels who did not keep their first domain, but deserted their own dwelling place, he has kept in everlasting bonds under darkness for the judgment of the great day.**

¹⁷ **Even as Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, having in the same way as these given themselves over to sexual immorality and gone after strange flesh, are shown as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire.²**

¹⁸ Yet in the same way, these also in their dreaming defile the flesh, despise authority, and slander celestial beings.

¹⁹ But Michael, the archangel, when contending with the devil and arguing about the body of Moses, dared not bring against him an abusive condemnation, but said, "May the Lord rebuke you!"

¹⁰ But these speak evil of whatever things they do not know. They are destroyed in these things that they understand naturally, like the creatures without reason.

¹¹ Woe to them! For they went in the way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error of Balaam for hire, and perished in Korah's rebellion.

¹² These are hidden rocky reefs in your love feasts when they feast with you, shepherds who without fear feed themselves; **clouds³** without water, carried along by winds; autumn **trees⁴** without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots;

¹³ wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering **stars⁵**, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.

¹⁴ About these also Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, saying, "Behold, the Lord came with ten thousands of his holy ones,

¹⁵ to execute judgment on all, and to convict all the ungodly of all their works of ungodliness which they have done in an ungodly way, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against him."

¹⁶ These are murmurers and complainers, walking after their lusts—and their mouth speaks proud things—showing respect of persons to gain advantage.

¹⁷ But you, beloved, remember the words which have been spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ.

¹⁸ They said to you, "In the last time there will be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts."

¹⁹ These are those who cause divisions and are sensual, not having the Spirit.

²⁰ But you, beloved, keep building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit.

²¹ Keep yourselves in God's love, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life.

²² On some have compassion, making a distinction,

²³ and some save, snatching them out of the fire with fear, hating even the clothing stained by the flesh.

²⁴ Now to him who is able to keep them from stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory in great joy,

²⁵ to God our Savior, who alone is wise, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and forever. Amen.

¹ Denial of Jesus is clearly evil in God's eyes.

² The fallen angels referred to in Rev 12:9 are described here "in like manner" to the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah, indulging in fornication and going after strange flesh. This tells us that the sin of the fallen angels was sexual in nature (Jude 6–7). Lucifer was the "old serpent" in the Garden of Eden who tempted Eve to sin. This ties the shame of Adam and Eve of their sexual parts—realizing they were naked after the Fall they covered themselves with aprons made of fig

leaves (Gen 3:7)—to the sexual sin between Eve and Lucifer (the serpent), and later between Eve and Adam.

³ In Jude 12 the term clouds refers to people (see Dan 7:13; Heb 12:1; Matt 24:30; 26:64; 1 Thess 4:16, Rev 1:7).

⁴ In Jude 12 the term trees refers to people (see Gen 2:9; Prov 11:30; 13:12; Matt 3:10; 12:33; John 15:4–6; Rom 11:17–18).

⁵ In Jude 12 the term stars refers to people (see Eccl 12:2; Isa 13:10; Ezek 32:7; Joel 2:10, 3:15; Matt 24:29; 1 Cor 15:41; Rev 8:12, 12:1).

REVELATION

THE REVELATION OF SAINT JOHN THE DIVINE

Brief background summary

Dating:

Scholars believe this book was written during the reign of Domitian, from 81–96 AD (about 51–66 years after the crucifixion of Jesus).

Authorship:

Traditionally, the author is thought to be the Apostle John, but modern scholars generally do not agree with this and believe the author was a Christian prophet, possibly from Patmos.

Refer to the maps for additional background information:

CHAPTER 1

¹¹ This is the Revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him to show to his servants the things which must happen soon, which he sent and made known by his angel to his servant, John,

¹² who testified to God's word and of the testimony of Jesus Christ, about everything that he saw.

¹³ Blessed is he who reads and those who hear the words of the prophecy, and keep the things that are written in it, for the time is at hand.

¹⁴ John, to the seven assemblies that are in Asia: Grace to you and peace from God, who is and who was and who is to come; and from the seven Spirits who are before his throne;

¹⁵ and from Jesus Christ, the faithful witness, the firstborn of the dead, and the ruler of the kings of the earth. To him who loves us, and washed us from our sins by his blood—

¹⁶ and he made us to be a Kingdom, priests to his God and Father—to him be the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen.

¹⁷ **Behold, he is coming with the clouds,⁶ and every eye will see him,⁷ including those who pierced him.⁸** All the tribes of the earth will mourn over him. Even so, Amen.

¹⁸ **"I am the Alpha and the Omega,"** says the Lord God, **"who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty."**

¹⁹ I John, your brother and partner with you in the oppression, Kingdom, and perseverance in Christ Jesus, was on the isle that is called Patmos because of God's Word and the testimony of Jesus Christ.

¹⁰ I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and I heard behind me a loud voice, like a trumpet

¹¹ saying, **"What you see, write in a book and send to the seven assemblies: to Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamum, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, and to Laodicea."**

¹² I turned to see the voice that spoke with me. Having turned, I saw seven golden lamp stands.

¹³ And among the lamp stands was one like a son of man, clothed with a robe reaching down to his feet, and with a golden sash around his chest.

¹⁴ His head and his hair were white as white wool, like snow. His eyes were like a flame of fire.

¹⁵ His feet were like burnished brass, as if it had been refined in a furnace. His voice was like the voice of many waters.

¹⁶ He had seven stars in his right hand. **Out of his mouth proceeded a sharp two-edged sword.⁹** His face was like the sun shining at its brightest.

⁶ A metaphor for followers, as in "a cloud of witnesses" (see Dan 7:13; Heb 12:1; Matt 24:30; 26:64; 1 Thess 4:16, Jude 12).

⁷ He will be known to all.

⁸ Jesus was literally pierced by a Roman soldier. The phrase has metaphorical meaning.

⁹ John is having a mystical experience which is filled with much metaphor and symbolism. Judgment based on God's word can be seen in Rev 1:16 as symbolized by a two-edged sword coming from the mouth of the Lord (cf. John 12:48; Heb 4:12; Rev 19:13–15).

¹⁷ When I saw him, I fell at his feet like a dead man. He laid his right hand on me, saying, **"Do not be afraid."**

I am the first and the last,

¹⁸ and the Living one. I was dead, and behold, I am alive forever and ever. Amen. I have the keys of Death and of hell.¹⁰

¹⁹ Write therefore the things which you have seen, and the things which are, and the things which will happen hereafter.

²⁰ The mystery of the seven stars which you saw in my right hand, and the seven golden lamp stands is this: The seven stars are the angels of the seven assemblies. The seven lamp stands are seven assemblies.

CHAPTER 2

²¹ **"To the angel of the assembly in Ephesus write: "He who holds the seven stars in his right hand, he who walks among the seven golden lamp stands says these things:**

²² "I know your works, and your toil and perseverance, and that you cannot tolerate evil men, and have tested those who call themselves apostles, and they are not, and found them false.

²³ You have perseverance and have endured for my name's sake, and have not grown weary.

²⁴ But I have this against you, that you left your first love.

²⁵ Remember therefore from where you have fallen, and repent and do the first works; or else I am coming to you swiftly, and will move your lamp stand out of its place, unless you repent.

²⁶ But this you have, that you hate the works of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate.

²⁷ He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. To him who overcomes I will give to eat from the tree of life,¹¹ which is in the Paradise of God.¹²

²⁸ "To the angel of the assembly in Smyrna write: "The first and the last, who was dead, and has come to life says these things:

²⁹ "I know your works, oppression, and your poverty (but you are rich), and the blasphemy of those who say they are Jews, and they are not, but are a synagogue of Satan.

³⁰ Do not be afraid of the things which you are about to suffer. Behold, the devil is about to throw some of you into prison, that you may be tested; and you will have oppression for ten days. Be faithful to death, and I will give you the crown of life.

³¹ He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. He who overcomes will not be harmed by the second death.

¹⁰ Jesus is obviously alive in the spirit as a part of this experience of John.

¹¹ In the garden of Eden, the Tree of Life was a symbol for fully matured and perfected Adam. He was blocked from the fulfillment of this—by cherubim (see Ezek 10) and a flaming sword (Gen 3:24)—as a consequence of his sin. Jesus is called by Paul "the last Adam" (1 Cor 15:45). Thus, Jesus can be said to be a new "Tree of Life".

¹² Luke 23:43

²¹² “To the angel of the assembly in Pergamum write: “He who has the sharp two-edged sword says these things:

²¹³ “I know your works and where you dwell, where Satan’s throne is. You hold firmly to my name, and did not deny my faith in the days of Antipas my witness, my faithful one, who was killed among you, where Satan dwells.

²¹⁴ But I have a few things against you, because you have there some who hold the teaching of Balaam, who taught Balak to throw a stumbling block before the children of Israel, to eat things sacrificed to idols, and to commit sexual immorality.

²¹⁵ So you also have some who hold to the teaching of the Nicolaitans likewise.

²¹⁶ Repent therefore, or else I am coming to you quickly, and I will make war against them **with the sword of my mouth.**

²¹⁷ He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. **To him who overcomes, to him I will give some of the hidden manna, and I will give him a white stone, and on the stone a new name written, which no one knows but he who receives it.**¹³

²¹⁸ “To the angel of the assembly in Thyatira write: “The Son of God, who has his eyes like a flame of fire, and his feet are like burnished brass, says these things:

²¹⁹ “I know your works, your love, faith, service, patient endurance, and that your last works are more than the first.

²²⁰ But I have this against you, that you tolerate your woman, Jezebel, who calls herself a prophetess. She teaches and seduces my servants to commit sexual immorality, and to eat things sacrificed to idols.

²²¹ I gave her time to repent, but she refuses to repent of her sexual immorality.

²²² Behold, I will throw her and those who commit adultery with her into a bed of great oppression, unless they repent of her works.

²²³ I will kill her children with Death, and all the assemblies will know that I am he who searches the minds and hearts. I will give to each one of you according to your deeds.

²²⁴ But to you I say, to the rest who are in Thyatira, as many as do not have this teaching, who do not know what some call ‘the deep things of Satan,’ to you I say, I am not putting any other burden on you.

²²⁵ Nevertheless, hold that which you have firmly until I come.

²²⁶ **He who overcomes, and he who keeps my works to the end, to him I will give authority over the nations.**

²²⁷ **He will rule them with a rod of iron, shattering them like clay pots; as I also have received of my Father.**¹⁴

²²⁸ and I will give him the morning star.

²²⁹ He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies.

CHAPTER 3

³¹ “And to the angel of the assembly in Sardis write: “He who has the seven Spirits of God and the seven stars says these things: **“I know your works, that you have a reputation of being alive, but you are dead.”**¹⁵

³² Wake up and keep the things that remain, which you were about to throw away, for I have found no works of yours perfected before my God.

³³ Remember therefore how you have received and heard. Keep it and repent. If therefore you will not watch, I will come as a thief, and you will not know what hour I will come upon you.

³⁴ Nevertheless you have a few names in Sardis that did not defile their garments. They will walk with me in white, for they are worthy.

³⁵ He who overcomes will be arrayed in white garments, and I will in no way blot his name out of the book of life, and I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels.

³⁶ He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies.

³⁷ “To the angel of the assembly in Philadelphia write: **“He who is holy, he who is true, he who has the key of David, he who opens and no one can shut, and who shuts and no one opens, says these things.”**¹⁶

³⁸ “I know your works (behold, I have set before you an open door, which no one can shut), that you have a little power, and kept my word, and did not deny my name.

³⁹ Behold, I give some of the synagogue of Satan, of those who say they are Jews, and they are not, but lie—behold, I will make them to come and worship before your feet, and to know that I have loved you.

³¹⁰ Because you kept my command to endure, I also will keep you from the hour of testing which is to come on the whole world, to test those who dwell on the earth.

³¹¹ **I am coming quickly!**¹⁷ Hold firmly that which you have, so that no one takes your crown.

³¹² He who overcomes, I will make him a pillar in the temple of my God, and he will go out from there no more. **I will write on him** the name of my God and the name of the city of my God, the new Jerusalem,

¹³ see Rev 3:12; 12:1–5; 19:12. The savior will return, born of a woman, with a new name.

¹⁴ Rev 2:26–27 is Jesus speaking of his return, but in the person of another, similar to the return of Elijah in the person of John the Baptist (see Rev 3:12, 21; 12:4–5; 19:11–16; Matt 11:13–14; 17:10–13; Mark 9:11–13; Luke 1:17).

¹⁵ Rev 3:1 distinguishes between physical life and death, and spiritual life and death. The people referred to are physically alive, but spiritually dead (see Topical Index #31).

¹⁶ Rev 3:7 appears to be the words of Jesus to the Churches.

¹⁷ While it is Jesus who says this, the Divine Principle asserts that he will return in the same manner as Elijah returned through John the Baptist in the time of Jesus, again through a special representative instead of himself (see EDP Part 1, Chapter 4, Section 2.4; and Rev 2:17, 26–27; 3:12, 21; 12:5; 19:11–16).

which comes down out of heaven from my God, and **my new name**.¹⁸

³¹³ He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies.

³¹⁴ "To the angel of the assembly in Laodicea write: "The Amen, the Faithful and True Witness, the Beginning of God's creation, says these things:

³¹⁵ "I know your works, that you are neither cold nor hot. I wish you were cold or hot.

³¹⁶ So, because you are lukewarm, and neither hot nor cold, I will vomit you out of my mouth.

³¹⁷ Because you say, 'I am rich, and have gotten riches, and have need of nothing;' and do not know that you are the wretched one, miserable, poor, blind, and naked;

³¹⁸ I counsel you to buy from me gold refined by fire, that you may become rich; and white garments, that you may clothe yourself, and that the shame of your nakedness may not be revealed; and eye salve to anoint your eyes, that you may see.

³¹⁹ As many as I love, I reprove and chasten. Be zealous therefore, and repent.

³²⁰ Behold, I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, then I will come in to him, and will dine with him, and he with me.

³²¹ **He who overcomes, I will give to him to sit down with me on my throne, as I also overcame, and sat down with my Father on his throne.**¹⁹

³²² He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies."

CHAPTER 4

⁴¹ After these things I looked and saw a door opened in heaven, and the first voice that I heard, like a trumpet speaking with me, was one saying, "Come up here, and I will show you the things which must happen after this."

⁴² Immediately I was in the Spirit. Behold, there was a throne set in heaven, and one sitting on the throne

⁴³ that looked like a jasper stone and a sardius. There was a rainbow around the throne, like an emerald to look at.

⁴⁴ Around the throne were twenty-four thrones. On the thrones were twenty-four elders sitting, dressed in white garments, with crowns of gold on their heads.

⁴⁵ Out of the throne proceed lightnings, sounds, and thunders. There were seven lamps of fire burning before his throne, which are the seven Spirits of God.

⁴⁶ Before the throne was something like a sea of glass, similar to crystal. In the middle of the throne, and around the throne were four living creatures full of eyes before and behind.

⁴⁷ The first creature was like a lion, and the second creature like a calf, and the third creature had a face like a man, and the fourth was like a flying eagle.

⁴⁸ The four living creatures, each one of them having six wings, are full of eyes around and within. They have no rest day and night, saying, "Holy, holy, holy is the Lord God, the Almighty, who was and who is and who is to come!"

⁴⁹ When the living creatures give glory, honor, and thanks to him who sits on the throne, to him who lives forever and ever,

⁴¹⁰ the twenty-four elders fall down before him who sits on the throne, and worship him who lives forever and ever, and throw their crowns before the throne, saying,

⁴¹¹ "Worthy are you, our Lord and God, the Holy One, to receive the glory, the honor, and the power, for you created all things, and because of your desire they existed, and were created!"

CHAPTER 5

⁵¹ **I saw, in the right hand of him who sat on the throne, a book written inside and outside, sealed shut with seven seals.**²⁰

⁵² I saw a mighty angel proclaiming with a loud voice, "Who is worthy to open the book, and to break its seals?"

⁵³ No one in heaven above, or on the earth, or under the earth, was able to open the book or to look in it.

⁵⁴ Then I wept much, because no one was found worthy to open the book or to look in it.

⁵⁵ One of the elders said to me, "Do not weep. Behold, the Lion who is of the tribe of Judah, the Root of David, has overcome: he who opens the book and its seven seals."

⁵⁶ I saw in the middle of the throne and of the four living creatures, and in the middle of the elders, a Lamb standing, as though it had been slain, having seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven Spirits of God, sent out into all the earth.

⁵⁷ Then he came, and he took it out of the right hand of him who sat on the throne.

⁵⁸ Now when he had taken the book, the four living creatures and the twenty-four elders fell down before the Lamb, each one having a harp, and golden bowls full of incense, which are the prayers of the saints.

⁵⁹ They sang a new song, saying, "You are worthy to take the book and to open its seals: for you were killed, and bought us for God with your blood out of every tribe, language, people, and nation,

⁵¹⁰ and made us kings and priests to our God, and we will reign on the earth."

⁵¹¹ I saw, and I heard something like a voice of many angels around the throne, the living creatures, and the

¹⁸ If the Lord returns with a new name, which no one knows, then again, his return may be likened to the return of Elijah in the person of John the Baptist (see Rev 2:17; 12:1-5; Matt 11:13-14; 17:10-13; Mark 9:11-13; Luke 1:17).

¹⁹ Rev 3:21 is Jesus saying that he "overcame" and therefore became the Christ, or Savior of all mankind. Furthermore, he is saying that the

one who overcomes will be like him (see Rev 2:26-27; 3:12; 12:4-5; 19:11-16).

²⁰ Rev 5:1 is the Father who sat on the throne, with a sealed book in His right hand (cf. Rev 7:10).

elders. The number of them was ten thousands of ten thousands, and thousands of thousands;

⁵**12** saying with a loud voice, "Worthy is the Lamb who has been killed to receive the power, wealth, wisdom, strength, honor, glory, and blessing!"

⁵**13** I heard every created thing which is in heaven, on the earth, under the earth, on the sea, and everything in them, saying, "To him who sits on the throne, and to the Lamb be the blessing, the honor, the glory, and the dominion, forever and ever! Amen!"

⁵**14** The four living creatures said, "Amen!" Then the elders fell down and worshiped.

Just before his execution, still struggling with his revelation about the divinity of Jesus, John sent some of his disciples to Jesus to ask him if he was really the one who was to come, or if he should look for another. Jesus responded, in Luke 7:22, *“Blessed is he who takes no offense at me.”* Later, Jesus said of John (Matt 11:11) *“Truly I say to you, among those born of women, there has risen no one greater than John the Baptist. Yet even the least in the Kingdom of Heaven is greater than he.”* To repeat: *“...even the least in the Kingdom of Heaven is greater than John.”* He added: *“From the days of John the Baptist, the kingdom of heaven has suffered violence, and men of violence take it by force.”* (Matt 11:12).

John did almost nothing after his proclamation at the Jordan River to testify to Jesus. He even contradicted Jesus, undercutting Jesus’ authority and credibility in the eyes of the Jewish people. Jesus said John was the Elijah who was prophesied to come, but John himself denied it... (Matt 17:10–13 and John 1:21)

If Jesus appeared at your door today, and you recognized who he was, wouldn't you become his disciple and testify to him?

Instead, Jesus was forced to find some ill-prepared disciples among the fishermen of the area. Most of them had no knowledge of the Mosaic law. They had very little faith in Jesus, and could hardly understand his simple parables. Were it not for Jesus’ resurrected appearance to them for 40 days after his death, these followers would have never started the Christian movement.

Jesus’ request from the beginning of his ministry was for people to *“believe in him whom God had sent.”* (John 6:29)

“Oh Jerusalem, Jerusalem, how I would have gathered you together as a hen gathers her brood under her wings, but you would not.” (Matt 23:37)

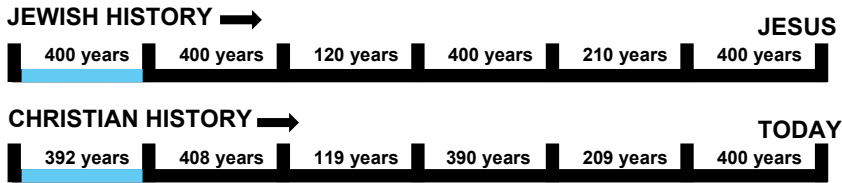
The apostle Luke said Jesus was betrayed and killed because they *“did not know the time of [their] visitation”* (Luke 19:42–44).

Matthew 10:15 tells of terrible judgment for those who reject even Jesus’ disciples. In John 10:38, Jesus pleads with the people that if they would not believe his words, that they at least believe his works, that they might be saved.

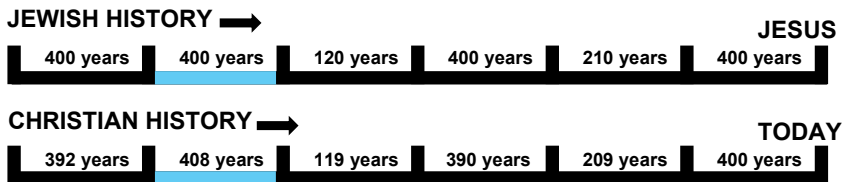
Jesus did everything he could to convince the people that he was the Son of God. But, without the continuing supportive testimony of a person like John the Baptist, which God had expected, the Jewish leaders could not believe. They even said Jesus’ miraculous powers came from the Devil.

Of them, Jesus said in Matthew 23:13–36, that those whom they led away from Jesus were becoming twice the children of hell as they themselves. Jesus was very angry with them.

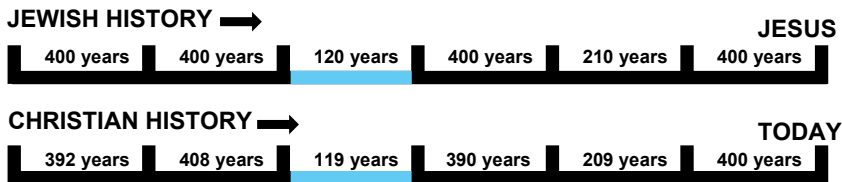
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We can see how the Christian faith sprang from the 12 apostles and 70 disciples of Jesus, paralleling the family of Jacob. For the next 400 years, Christians suffered even more than the Jews had in Egypt. They were boiled in hot oil, fed to lions, and burned alive as torches at the Roman Emperor's garden parties. But Christians again became strengthened and deepened in their faith, and became the convicted believers who could spread Jesus's teachings throughout the world.



In 392 AD Augustine, somewhat like Moses, helped to liberate Christians from their suffering, this time by making Christianity the legal religion of Rome. This was followed by another 400 years of a feudal Christian society. Sound familiar? Seven Holy Sees were ruled by leaders who stood in the combined positions of monastic, pope and king, echoing the period of the Jewish Judges. But unfortunately once again, there was no unity among the Holy Sees.



On Christmas Day, 800 AD, Pope Leo III crowned Charlemagne as the first Christian Roman Emperor. He and his sons and grandsons reigned for about 120 years, again reminiscent of the 120 year period of the three Jewish kings.

